

Конверсии Roth – 12 мая 2026 г.

Когда конверсии Roth не подходят: 4 причины, по которым они не подходят



4 Reasons NOT to do Roth Conversions

Craig Wear, CFP®



Пожизненные сбережения

\$1 млн+

в среднем на одного клиента с индивидуальным пенсионным планом

Построенные планы

2400+

Игровые планы по превращению Рота

Неудачная конверсия Roth может быть вызвана четырьмя причинами. Конверсия Roth не подходит, если вам меньше 59,5 лет и у вас нет наличных денег, чтобы заплатить налог, если вам далеко за 70 и у вас нет цели оставить наследство, если у вас слишком маленький индивидуальный пенсионный счет, чтобы избежать проблемы с минимальным распределением, или если вы находитесь в аннуитете, который конвертируется только по принципу «все или ничего».

[Оглавление](#)

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Конвертация Roth действительно неправильна в четырех ситуациях: вам меньше 59 с половиной лет, у вас нет внешних наличных для уплаты налога, вам перевалило за 70, у вас нет цели унаследовать наследство, ваша IRA достаточно мала, чтобы будущие RMD никогда не повышали вашу планку, уровень IRMAA или налогообложение социального обеспечения, или ваша IRA находится внутри аннуитета, который carrier конвертирует только в полном объеме. Все остальное - это переменная для моделирования, а не вердикт.

Четыре основные причины для дисквалификации

Четыре веские причины, по которым не стоит конвертировать Roth: сроки, математика и структура. Каждая из них — это отправная точка для анализа, а не автоматическое «нет», потому что одно исключение может изменить решение. В таблице ниже приведены все четыре условия, причины, по которым каждое из них не подходит, а также исключение, которое может вернуть вопрос на повестку дня.



Получите реальный ответ о конвертации Roth

Команда Craig Wear разработала более 2400 многолетних прогнозов конверсии для семей-миллионеров IRA по каждому сценарию выхода на пенсию. Узнайте, соответствует ли конверсия Roth вашей ситуации — без представления продукта и без каких-либо обязательств.

Свяжитесь с Q3 сегодня

		его
Менее 59,5 % без привлечения внешних средств	Штраф в размере 10% за досрочное снятие средств со счета IRA, используемого для уплаты налогов, уменьшает сумму конвертации	Сначала переведите нераспределенные взносы по программе 401(k) на налогооблагаемый счет
Мне уже за 70, и я не стремлюсь к богатству	Оставшийся срок службы слишком мал, чтобы достичь точки безубыточности	Heirs-focused conversion under the SECURE Act 10-year rule
Индивидуальный пенсионный счет слишком мал по сравнению с доходом	Будущие обязательные минимальные выплаты никогда не повысят ваш налоговый статус, уровень по шкале IRMAA или размер налога на социальное обеспечение.	Targeted conversions only if a specific threshold is within reach
Most assets locked in an annuity	Carrier may allow only full-contract conversion in one tax year	Confirm partial-conversion rules with the issuing carrier



Reason 1: Under age 59½ with no outside cash to pay the tax

A Roth conversion is usually wrong before age 59½ if you have no cash outside the IRA to pay the tax. The conversion itself is not penalized, but pulling extra IRA dollars to cover the bill triggers the 10% early withdrawal penalty. Without outside funds, the conversion either shrinks or gets penalized, defeating the purpose.

federal tax on about \$40,000 converted. Pay that tax from the IRA before 59½ and the IRS adds a 10% penalty on the dollars withdrawn to cover it.

One workaround exists for people still working. After capturing the full employer 401(k) match, they can pause unmatched contributions and route that cash into a taxable account. Those after-tax dollars can fund the tax on the conversion. A conversion is taxable ordinary income but is not itself net investment income, so it does not trigger the net investment income tax. Before deciding, many investors model [how much to convert to a Roth each year](#).



Reason 2: Past your mid-70s with no estate goals

A Roth conversion is usually wrong past your mid-70s if you have no estate goal. Conversions trade tax now for tax savings later, and the payoff needs years to arrive. Financial Planning Association research places typical break-even ages between roughly 88 and 100, so a retiree in their late 70s or 80s may not live to recover the upfront cost.

Required minimum distributions begin at age 73, or age 75 for anyone born in 1960 or later (the earliest age-75 RMD year is 2035). If you will spend down the IRA through RMDs and normal living expenses, converting rarely improves your own tax picture at that age.

The math flips when the goal is your heirs. Under the SECURE Act 10-year rule, a non-spouse beneficiary must empty an inherited traditional IRA within ten years, and every withdrawal is ordinary income. Heirs often inherit in their 50s, their peak earning years, so those distributions can land in a higher bracket than yours. A Roth passes income-tax-free, which can flip a late-life conversion back to worthwhile. Weigh it against [the break-even math on a Roth conversion](#).

Reason 3: An IRA too small to create an RMD problem

A Roth conversion is usually wrong when your IRA is too small to create a required minimum distribution problem. Conversions exist to defuse future RMDs that inflate taxable income. Below roughly \$600,000 of pre-tax balance, and depending on other income, RMDs often stay inside your current bracket, so converting only accelerates tax you would have paid at the same rate.



Consider a \$500,000 traditional IRA. The first RMD at age 73 is about \$18,868. For a household with modest Social Security and no large pension, that amount may not lift Social Security taxation, cross an IRMAA tier, or raise the federal bracket, so the RMD is simply taxed where the household already sits.

Modest is relative to total income, not an absolute IRA figure. A \$500,000 balance beside a \$30,000 pension behaves very differently from the same balance beside \$90,000 of other income. Review [how required minimum distributions work in 2026](#) before assuming an RMD problem exists.

Reason 4: An IRA locked inside an annuity that converts all-or-nothing

A Roth conversion is often blocked when most of your IRA sits inside an annuity. This disqualifier is structural, not mathematical. Many variable and indexed annuity contracts let the carrier convert only the entire contract at once, so a \$500,000 annuity cannot be partially converted. A full conversion can create an enormous one-year tax bill and may destroy income or death-benefit riders.

questions before assuming a conversion plan is possible:

- Can this contract be converted to a Roth IRA at this carrier?
- Can it be converted in partial amounts, or is full-contract conversion the only option?

If the answers are no and full-contract only, the plan has to work around the annuity rather than through it. This constraint is structural rather than tax-driven, and it can quietly shape the strategy for many insurance-heavy accounts.



Objections that feel like disqualifiers but are not

Several common objections are not disqualifiers. A higher bracket, an IRMAA tier, more taxable Social Security, or lower-bracket heirs are variables to weigh in a multi-year projection, not automatic reasons to skip a conversion. Treating any single one of them as a verdict can cause a household to overlook potential lifetime tax savings that a full analysis might reveal.

“You will cross into a higher tax bracket”

This confuses marginal and effective rates. Crossing into the 32% bracket taxes only the dollars above the threshold at 32%, not the whole conversion. In 2026 the 24% bracket runs to \$201,775 (single) and \$403,550 (joint), leaving wide room to convert before the next rate applies. If future RMDs will sit in the 32% to 37% range for life, paying 22% or 24% now can still come out ahead.

“It will raise your Medicare premium (IRMAA)”

63 can affect premiums at 65. The standard Part B premium is \$202.90. A conversion year that crosses a tier raises premiums for two years only, which a multi-year plan weighs against decades of lower RMDs.

“More of your Social Security will be taxed”

Adding conversion income can push a household across the provisional-income thresholds that make up to 85% of Social Security benefits taxable. That cost is real but often temporary. Converting in lower-income years, before Social Security starts or between claiming and RMD age, is frequently how a plan reduces the total tax on benefits.



“Your heirs are in a lower bracket, so leave it traditional”

This is frequently backward. Under the SECURE Act 10-year rule, non-spouse heirs must drain an inherited traditional IRA within ten years, usually during their own peak earning years in their 50s. Those stacked distributions can land in a higher bracket than the retiree's, so converting at your lower rate today, then passing a tax-free Roth, can win.

“You are charitable, so a conversion is unnecessary”

Charitable intent can reduce the case for converting, but it does not erase it. Qualified charitable distributions (QCDs) let someone age 70½ or older send money directly from an IRA to charity tax-free and count toward RMDs. QCDs come only from an IRA, not a 401(k). For balances larger than your giving plans, conversions and QCDs often work together.

itself. That makes sizing each conversion carefully more important than any single objection. See the [2026 Roth conversion deadline](#).

What 2026 tax law changed for Roth conversions

The 2026 rules removed the old urgency. The One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA, P.L. 119-21) made the lower TCJA brackets permanent, so the “convert before the 2026 sunset” pressure is gone. Timing a conversion is now about your own income years, not a looming rate increase. Current-law figures, not expiring ones, are the ones that now drive the math.



For 2026 the standard deduction is \$16,100 (single) and \$32,200 (joint), with an extra \$2,050 (single) or \$1,650 per spouse at age 65 and older. A temporary senior deduction of \$6,000 per person age 65 and older applies for tax years 2025 through 2028. These widen the room to convert at low effective rates. To plan the calendar, many investors review [Q3's Roth conversion planning](#).

Frequently asked questions

When should you not do a Roth conversion?

You should generally skip a Roth conversion in four situations: you are under 59½ with no outside cash to pay the tax, you are past your mid-70s with no legacy goal, your IRA is too small for future RMDs to raise your bracket, or your IRA is locked inside an annuity that converts only in full. Other concerns are variables to model, not reasons to stop.

At what age does a Roth conversion not make sense?

retiree in their late 70s or 80s may not live to recover the upfront tax. If the goal is heirs under the SECURE Act 10-year rule, late-life conversions can still make sense.

Is there a downside to converting to a Roth IRA?

Yes. A conversion is taxable ordinary income in the year you do it, it is irreversible with no recharacterization, and the deadline is December 31. It can raise your bracket, increase IRMAA premiums, and make more Social Security taxable in that year. These are manageable trade-offs to model across many years, not automatic reasons to avoid converting.



How much is too much to convert to a Roth in one year?

Too much is any amount that pushes income past a threshold whose cost outweighs the long-term benefit, such as a much higher bracket, a steep IRMAA tier, or heavy Social Security taxation. “Fill the current bracket” is a rule of thumb that can overshoot or undershoot; the right amount comes from a multi-year projection.

Who should not convert to a Roth IRA?

People under 59½ with no outside cash, retirees deep into their 70s or 80s with no estate goal, households whose IRA is small enough that RMDs never raise their bracket or IRMAA tier, and owners whose IRA sits in an annuity the carrier will convert only in full. For everyone else, converting is a question to model, not to dismiss.

Does a Roth conversion affect Medicare premiums?

It can. IRMAA uses modified adjusted gross income from two years earlier, so a conversion at age 63 or later can raise Part B and Part D premiums at 65 and beyond. In 2026 surcharges begin above \$109,000 MAGI (single) or \$218,000 (joint), and the base Part B premium is \$202.90. The increase lasts two years and can be weighed against long-term savings.

It can be, depending on the goal. For your own lifetime, the break-even window shortens each year, so a personal-benefit conversion at 70 is a closer call. For heirs, the SECURE Act 10-year rule often makes conversions after 70 valuable, because beneficiaries would otherwise withdraw the traditional IRA during their peak earning years.

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